

in category three and displeased with their old financial planners.

But in times like these, when terms like “Meltdown Monday” and (ssshhh . . . the “r” word) are being tossed around, financial planners around the world are waking up in the middle of the night in cold sweats. Try as they may to buffer their clients against market downturns, statements will look bad. And they will be sure to hear about it. And ultimately, through no fault of their own, they will lose clients.

Some planners, though, will lose clients, and arguably deserve to. They will not have performed the proper amount of due diligence with their clients by assessing their investment personalities and time frames, and instead of facing the music when their clients call, they may instead choose to hide under their desks as a way to weather the storm. They will not have addressed their clients’ larger financial situation and dealt with issues like taxation, short- and long-term savings, and estate planning, and will instead have simply focused on returns—something which can never be promised and will never be predictable (unless you are invested solely in term deposits, in which case again I would suggest the advisor’s incompetence).

If you are experiencing statement shock, or are wondering if your

financial planner is up to snuff, here are nine signs you may need to fire your financial planner.



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1. They never asked you about your personal goals and time frames before recommending investments.

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There is no such thing as a one-size-fits-all investment plan. Although having a standard set of investment recommendations according to your stated time frame and tolerance for risk is acceptable, they must do the initial groundwork to determine who you are and what you want from your money.

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2. Only one company’s products are recommended.

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As good as that company’s products are, true diversification includes not only a range of asset classes, but also a range of investment managers. Recommending only one type of company-labeled product indicates